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Vehicle braking system comprising a parking brake indicator device and vehicle provided with such a braking system

Abstract

A braking system for a vehicle includes an indicator device provided to reliably indicate a state of a parking brake of the system, while being simple, convenient, and economical. The system includes a body that delimits a service brake pressure chamber and/or a parking brake pressure chamber, a parking brake movable relative to the body, an unlocking part for unlocking the parking brake connected to the parking brake pressure chamber and accessible from outside the body, and a parking brake indicator device. The indicator device is configured to receive a position of the unlocking part via a state pipe and an indicator of supply and/or the venting of the service brake pressure chamber and/or of the parking brake pressure chamber. This information is processed in to detect and indicate an engaged state or a disengaged state of the parking brake.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a national stage entry of, and claims priority to, International Patent Application No. PCT/FR2020/050416 (filed 2 Mar. 2020), which claims priority to French Patent Application No. 1902196 (filed 4 Mar. 2019). The entire contents of these applications are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(2) The invention concerns the field of rail vehicle brakes. More particularly, it concerns a braking system for a rail vehicle, comprising an indicator device provided to indicate a state of a parking brake of said braking system. It also concerns the rail vehicles comprising such a system.

Discussion Of Art

(3) Rail vehicles are generally equipped with service brake cylinders comprising a piston movable under the effect of a fluid under pressure, the movement of that piston driving a braking action such as the clamping of a disk brake between two linings, or the direct pressure of a block against a vehicle wheel.

(4) These brake cylinders also generally comprise a parking or emergency actuator which is actuated in case of pressure loss of the fluid under pressure and/or in case of intentional venting (or draining) or leakage of the pneumatic system. This actuator, also termed parking brake, makes it possible to provide braking by virtue of the load of one or more springs substituting for the load of the fluid. Once this parking brake has been activated, the brake remains continuously engaged.

(5) A rail vehicle braking system is known from European patent application EP 2 154 040 which is provided in particular with a parking brake actuator coupled to a rail vehicle service brake cylinder. Such a parking brake makes it possible to provide braking by virtue of the load of a spring substituting for the load of the fluid.

(6) From European patent application EP 2 826 684 there is also known a rail vehicle braking system provided in particular with a parking brake disposed in the service brake cylinder and comprising a blocking device configured to act on a rod of the brake piston of the service brake, and an actuating device of the blocking device. The blocking device and the actuating device are configured such that, when the braking piston is in a service braking position and the parking brake is in working configuration, the actuating device acts on said blocking device until the latter immobilizes the piston rod so as to block the braking piston in its service braking position, and when the parking brake is in resting configuration, the actuating device acts on the blocking device until the latter releases the piston rod so as to unblock the braking piston from its service braking position.

(7) These braking systems are mounted on the rail vehicle, to be in contact with the brake disks or the wheels. In particular, they may be mechanically connected to the bogies, or to the axles fastened to the bogies, or on other devices like the drive motor or the gearbox also mounted on the bogies.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(8) One or more embodiments of the inventive subject matter concern a braking system for a vehicle (e.g., a rail vehicle), where the braking system comprises an indicator device provided to reliably indicate a state of a parking brake of the system, while being simple, convenient, and economical.

(9) According to a first aspect, the invention relates to a rail vehicle braking system comprising a body delimiting a service brake pressure chamber and/or a parking brake pressure chamber, a parking brake movable relative to the body, an unlocking part for unlocking the parking brake

connected to the parking brake pressure chamber and accessible from outside the body, and a parking brake indicator device. The indicator device is configured to receive a first item of information representing a position of the unlocking part via a state pipe configured to be connected to the unlocking part. The indicator device also is configured to receive at least one second item of information representing the supply and/or the venting of the service brake pressure chamber and/or of the parking brake pressure chamber, via at least one other state pipe configured to be connected to a service brake pipe and/or to a parking brake. The first item of information is processed in combination with the at least one second item of information so as to detect and indicate an engaged state or a disengaged state of the parking brake.

(10) The indicator device of the braking system is thus configured to detect and indicate the state in which the parking brake of the braking system is in taking into account not only the position of the unlocking part for unlocking the parking brake but also the state of the service brake pressure chamber and/or the state of the parking brake pressure chamber.

(11) Taking into consideration the state of the service brake pressure chamber and/or the state of the parking brake pressure chamber may be carried out by receiving an item of information directly concerning the pressure in these chambers or else concerning settings for application of the parking brake and/or of the service brake.

(12) It will be noted that the rail vehicle braking system may comprise a braking linkage configured to act on at least one brake of a rail vehicle having a lining or a block. The braking system also can include a service brake comprising a braking piston movable relative to the body to act on the braking linkage and delimiting (with the body) the service brake pressure chamber. The service brake pressure chamber is configured to be supplied by a first source of pneumatic pressure agent to place the braking piston in a service braking position. The parking brake may be configured to act on the braking piston of the service brake and takes a working configuration and a resting configuration. The parking brake may comprise a blocking device which is movable relative to the body to act on the braking piston and can take a first position and a second position in which the blocking device is configured to immobilize the braking piston in service braking position (the parking brake then being in working configuration). The parking brake may comprise an actuating device which is movable relative to the body and which has a locking position in which the actuating device is configured to hold the blocking device in its second position. The rail vehicle braking system may be configured to supply the service brake pressure chamber with another pneumatic pressure agent of which the value of the pressure is determined, so as to apply a determined braking force when the parking brake is in working configuration.

(13) Features according to the inventive subject matter that are preferred, simple, convenient, and economical are presented below.

(14) The indicator device is configured to receive an item of information representing the supply of the service brake pressure chamber by a pneumatic pressure agent, via a second state pipe which is connected to a parking brake setting pipe, and an item of information representing the supply of the service brake pressure chamber by another pneumatic pressure agent, via a third state pipe which is connected to a service brake pipe.

(15) The unlocking part is coupled to a switch of the indicator device which is mechanically connected to that part and has a first position and a second position.

(16) The indicator device comprises a first parking contactor device mechanically connected the unlocking part, a second parking contactor device which is connected via the first state pipe to the first parking contactor device, a third parking contactor device, and a fourth parking contactor device which are each connected via the second state pipe to the parking brake setting pipe. The third and fourth parking contactor devices are respectively connected to the second parking contactor device and to respective visual parking indication devices of the indicator device.

(17) The second parking contactor device may be electrically supplied via an electrical source.

(18) The third and fourth respective parking contactor devices may be formed by pressure switches

or sensors.

(19) The parking brake is in an engaged state and the visual parking indication device is on when the second parking contactor device receives an item of information from the first state pipe (according to which the unlocking part is in an unlocking position) and the fourth parking contactor device receives an item of information from the second state pipe (according to which there is a parking brake setting in the parking brake pipe corresponding to a setting for application of the parking brake).

(20) The parking brake is in a disengaged state and the visual parking indication device is on when the second parking contactor device receives an item of information from the first state pipe (according to which the unlocking part is in an unlocking position) and the third parking contactor device receives an item of information from the second state pipe (according to which the parking brake setting has a null value in the parking brake pipe).

(21) The indicator device comprises a first parking contactor device mechanically connected to the unlocking part, a second parking contactor device connected via a first state pipe to the first parking contactor device, and a third contactor device connected to another state pipe itself joined either to a supply pipe of the parking brake, or to a setting pipe of the parking brake.

(22) The parking brake is in the engaged state and a visual parking indication device is then turned on when the second parking contactor device receives an item of information from the state pipe (according to which the unlocking part is in a locking position) and the third parking contactor device receives an item of information from the other state pipe (according to which there is a parking brake setting and/or when the parking brake pressure chamber of the system is not supplied, corresponding to a setting for application of the parking brake).

(23) The parking brake is in the disengaged state and the other of the visual parking indication devices is then turned on, whatever the item of information received by the third parking contactor device when the second parking contactor device receives an item of information from the state pipe (according to which the unlocking part is in an unlocking position).

(24) According to a second aspect, the inventive subject matter also relates to a vehicle such as a rail vehicle with brakes having at least one lining or at least one block. The vehicle includes at least one braking system as described above and configured to act on the at least one lining or on the at least one block of the rail vehicle.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The disclosure of the inventive subject matter will now be continued with the description of embodiments, given below by way of illustrative and non-limiting examples, with reference to the accompanying drawings.

(2) FIG. 1 is a diagrammatic and partial illustration of a braking system provided in particular with a service brake, a parking brake, and a control and actuation unit.

(3) FIG. 2 represents diagrammatically and in more detail the control and actuation unit illustrated in FIG. 1 and a conveyance network of pipes of the system, which is connected to that unit.

(4) FIG. 3 shows in more detail part of the control and actuation unit illustrated in FIG. 2 (e.g., a parking brake and/or service brake indicator device of the braking system).

(5) FIG. 4 shows the part of the indicator device illustrated in FIG. 3 and which is in particular provided to indicate a state of the parking brake.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates a first configuration of the parking brake.

(7) FIG. 6 illustrates a second configuration of the parking brake.

(8) FIG. 7 illustrates a third configuration of the parking brake.

(9) FIG. 8 shows the part of the indicator device illustrated in FIG. 3 and which is in particular

provided to indicate a state of the service brake.

(10) FIG. **9** shows a first variant embodiment of the part of the indicator device provided to indicate a state of the service brake.

(11) FIG. **10** shows a second variant embodiment of the part of the indicator device provided to indicate a state of the service brake.

(12) FIG. **11** shows a third variant embodiment of the part of the indicator device provided to indicate a state of the service brake.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(13) FIG. **1** diagrammatically represents a braking system **1** for a rail vehicle with a brake having linings or blocks.

(14) This is a rail vehicle braking system structurally of the type described in European patent application EP 2 826 684.

(15) The rail vehicle braking system **1** comprises a body **2** here forming a cylinder of a service brake **6** and a parking brake **7**, a control and actuation unit **3** configured to manage the operation of the service brake **6** and of the parking brake **7**, a conveyance network of pneumatic pipes that is connected to the body **2** and to the control and actuation unit **3**, a braking linkage **4** mechanically linked to the body **2**, and a brake **5** with linings on which the braking linkage **4** is configured to act.

(16) The body **2** here has the form of a generally closed envelope.

(17) The service brake **6** comprises a service brake piston **8** movable relative to the body **2** in a first axial direction, and a thrust rod **9** also movable relative to the body **2** in a second axial direction perpendicular to the first axial direction.

(18) Together with the body **2**, the braking piston **8** delimits a service brake pressure chamber **13**.

(19) The braking piston **8** has two sides respectively a first side **17** configured to act on the braking linkage **4** via the thrust rod **9** and a second side **18** which is an opposite side to the first side **17** and which is turned towards the service brake pressure chamber **13**.

(20) The service brake **6** further comprises a notched rod **21** fastened to the second side **18** of the braking piston **8**. This notched rod **21** extends longitudinally in the first axial direction.

(21) The braking piston **8** is configured to move in the body **2** while maintaining the service brake pressure chamber **13** relatively fluid-tight thanks to a membrane **14**, for example formed by a seal, disposed between that braking piston **8** and inside edges of the body **2**.

(22) The service brake **6** may further comprise a wedge part **10** fastened to the first side **17** of the braking piston **8**.

(23) This wedge part **10** may have a triangular section and be configured to cooperate with a set of rolling bearing stops **11**, of which one of the rolling bearing stops may be linked to the body **2** while the other of the rolling bearing stops may be linked to the thrust rod **9**.

(24) This thrust rod **9** may be provided with a wear adjuster configured to compensate for the wear of the linings of the brake **5** in order to avoid reduction of the braking force by excessive play (further to wear of the linings).

(25) The service brake **6** may comprise a spring **12** disposed around the thrust rod **9**, between the rolling bearing stop which is linked to the latter and an inside edge of the body **2**. This spring **12** is configured to return the stop which is linked to the thrust rod **9** against the wedge part **10**.

(26) The service brake **6** may comprise a first aperture **15** formed in the body **2** and configured to enable the movement of the thrust rod **9** through that first aperture **15**.

(27) The service brake **6** may comprise a second aperture **16** formed in the body **2** and opening into the service brake pressure chamber **13**.

(28) The service brake pressure chamber **13** is connected here by a first supply pipe **72** of the conveyance network of pneumatic pipes, more generally called brake pipe, which pipe is connected at the location of that second aperture **16**, to a source of supply of pneumatic pressure agents **73** (visible in FIG. **2**).

(29) The body **2** comprises a cavity **27** situated against the service brake pressure chamber **13** and

in which is disposed the parking brake **7**.

(30) The parking brake **7** comprises a blocking device formed by a blocking finger **20** movable relative to the body **2** and extending in the second axial direction.

(31) The parking brake **7** comprises a holding piston **23** movable relative to the body **2** and with the latter delimiting a parking brake pressure chamber **25**.

(32) This holding piston **23** has two sides, respectively a first side **31** on which is attached the blocking finger **20** and which is turned towards the parking brake pressure chamber **25**, and a second side **32** which is an opposite side to the first side.

(33) The parking brake **7** comprises a spring member **24** disposed between the body **2** and the second side **32** of the holding piston **23**. This spring member **24** is configured to act on that holding piston **23** and therefore on the blocking finger **20**.

(34) The holding piston **23** and the spring member **24** may form a movable actuating device of the parking brake **7**.

(35) The holding piston **23** is configured to move in the body **2** while maintaining the parking brake pressure chamber **25** relatively fluid-tight thanks to a membrane disposed between that holding piston **23** and the inside edges of the body **2**.

(36) The parking brake **7** comprises a third aperture (not shown) formed in the body **2** and opening both into the parking brake pressure chamber **25** and into the service brake pressure chamber **13**, which third aperture is configured to enable the movement of the blocking finger **20** through that third aperture.

(37) The relative sealing between the parking brake pressure chamber **25** and the service brake pressure chamber **13** is ensured by the presence of a seal **33** disposed at the interface between that third aperture and the blocking finger **20**.

(38) The parking brake **7** comprises a fourth aperture **28** formed in the body **2** and opening into the parking brake pressure chamber **25**.

(39) The parking brake pressure chamber **25** may be connected here by a second supply pipe **71** of the conveyance network of pneumatic pipes, also called parking brake pipe, which is connected at the location of that fourth aperture **28**, to the source of supply of pneumatic pressure agents **73** (visible in FIG. 2) via the unit **3**.

(40) The parking brake **7** comprises an unlocking part **29** to deactivate the parking brake **7**.

(41) The unlocking part **29** may for example be attached on the second side **32** of the holding piston **23** and open to the outside of the body **2** through a fifth aperture (not shown) provided in that body **2** and opening into the cavity **27**.

(42) The unlocking part **29** is accessible to be manipulated from outside the body **2** if required.

(43) As explained later, the unlocking part **29** is connected to an indicator device provided to indicate a state of the parking brake **7** and/or a state of the service brake **6**.

(44) In particular, the unlocking part **29** may be coupled to a switch mechanically connected to that part **29** and having a first position and a second position selected according to the position of the unlocking part **29**.

(45) The service brake **6** is disposed in the body **2** and is configured to act on the brake **5** via the braking linkage **4**.

(46) This brake **5** may comprise a brake disk **35** (here viewed from above) mounted for example on a rail vehicle axle **36**, or directly on the wheel to brake.

(47) This brake **5** may comprise two shoes **37** each provided with a lining **38** configured to be applied in contact with the disk **35** to reduce its rotational speed and therefore that of the wheel to brake, as well as a fastening eye **39** provided at the remote opposite location to the surface of the lining **38** that is configured to be applied to the disk brake **35**.

(48) The braking linkage **4** may comprise two or four deformable levers **40** each provided with an upper portion and a lower portion which are attached to each other. Only two levers are illustrated here and, in the case of the linkage having four levers, they may be attached in pairs or as a variant

be independent from each other.

(49) Each portion of the levers **40** may be jointed to a central connector **41** via two pivots **42**.

(50) The lower portion of each deformable lever **40** may be linked to one of the shoes **37** via its fastening eye **39**.

(51) The upper portion of each deformable lever **40** may be linked to a respective joint **44**, **45**.

(52) The braking linkage **4** may receive the body **2** between the upper portions of the deformable levers **40**, at the location of the joints **44** and **45**.

(53) The body **2** may be rotatably mounted on the joint **44** which is attached to an end of the thrust rod **9** whereas it may have a fixed mounting to the joint **45**, which is directly attached to that body **2**.

(54) The braking linkage **4** may comprise a fastening lug **43** joined to the central connector **41** for the mounting of that braking linkage **4** on the rail vehicle; in order for the brake shoes **37** to be situated on respective opposite sides of the brake disk **35** (or of the wheel of the rail vehicle).

(55) The coming towards each other of the joints **44** and **45** may enable the shoes **37** to move apart from each other and that conversely, the separation of those joints **44** and **45** may enable the shoes **37** to be clamped onto the brake disk **35** (or onto the rail vehicle wheel).

(56) The control and actuation unit **3** is connected to the service brake pressure chamber **13** via the first supply pipe **72** to which it is connected.

(57) This unit **3** is connected to the parking brake pressure chamber **25** via the second supply pipe **71** to which it is connected.

(58) This unit **3** is supplied with pneumatic agents by a main pipe **70** which passes generally along the rail vehicle.

(59) The unit **3** comprises system members (not shown in FIG. **1**) which are configured to receive and process representational information relative for example to operational settings of the rail vehicle, by a first electrical and/or pneumatic and/or manual type channel, denoted **50** in FIG. **1**.

(60) These system members are furthermore configured to receive and process representational information relative to parameters of use of the rail vehicle, by a second channel of electrical and/or pneumatic and/or manual type, which is denoted **60** in FIG. **1**.

(61) These system members may for example be formed by pneumatic relays and/or solenoids and/or pressure switches and/or sensors and/or pressure reducing valves and/or electrical relays and/or electronic cards and/or central processing units or microprocessors, and/or random access memory components comprising registers adapted to record variables of the parameters created and modified during the execution of programs, and/or communication interfaces configured to send and receive data, and/or internal storage members, such as hard disks, able in particular to store the executable code of programs enabling the management of the service and parking brakes **6** and **7**.

(62) The control and actuation unit **3** is associated here with a braking linkage and with a single brake **5** of the rail vehicle.

(63) As a variant, such a control and actuation unit may be associated with an axle (not shown) of the rail vehicle, provided with a plurality of brakes **5**, or with a bogie (not shown) of the rail vehicle, provided with two axles, or for instance with a wagon (not shown) of the rail vehicle, provided with two bogies, or it is possible for the rail vehicle to comprise only a single such control and actuation unit.

(64) FIG. **2** diagrammatically represents the conveyance network of pneumatic pipes and the control and actuation unit **3**.

(65) The main pipe **70** forms the channel for conveyance of a pneumatic agent distributed in the conveyance network of pneumatic pipes.

(66) The agent in this main pipe **70** may for example be at a pressure value of approximately 9 bars.

(67) The network may comprise what is referred to as a general pipe (not shown), distinct from the main pipe **70**, and generally extending in parallel thereto.

(68) The general pipe may enable pneumatic continuity to be ensured along the rail vehicle and may authorize the service braking of the vehicle, by directly using the fluid passing through the general pipe.

(69) As regards the main pipe **70**, this may enable equipment particularly for example of the rail vehicle braking system to be supplied, and in particular the source of supply of pneumatic pressure agents **73** here formed by what is referred to as an auxiliary reservoir.

(70) This network may comprise a filling and distribution pipe **74** which may be tapped onto (that is to say directly connected to) the main pipe **70**, and/or a service brake pipe **75** connected by a tapping **81** onto the filling and distribution pipe **74**, and/or an emergency brake pipe **76** tapped onto the service brake pipe **75** by a tapping **82**, and/or a control pipe **78** connected by a tapping **83** onto the filling and distribution pipe **74**.

(71) The control pipe **78** may be subdivided into two pipes at the location of a branch tapping **84**, respectively to form the parking brake pipe **71** directly communicating with the parking brake pressure chamber **25** and into an oversupply pipe, referred to hereinafter as preset pipe **79** or parking brake pipe or for instance parking brake setting pipe.

(72) Each service brake pipe **75** and/or emergency brake pipe **76** and/or preset pipe **79** may join the brake pipe **72** which directly communicates with the service brake pressure chamber **13**.

(73) The filling and distribution pipe **74** may have a first filling section extending between the tapping (not shown) onto the main pipe **70** and the auxiliary reservoir **73**, as well as a second distribution section extending from a tapping **80** onto the first section.

(74) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise a one-way valve **85** disposed on the first section of the filling and distribution pipe **74** near the tapping of the latter onto the main pipe **70**, and possibly an isolation tap **86** also disposed on that first section.

(75) The non-return valve **85** may enable the filling of the auxiliary reservoir **73** by the pneumatic pressure agent coming from the main pipe **70** and prohibit the venting of the reservoir **73** into the main pipe **70** if the pressure in the latter becomes less than that in the auxiliary reservoir **73**.

(76) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise a relay device **93**, or pneumatic relay, supplied by the second distribution section of the filling and distribution pipe **74** and connected to the brake pipe **72**.

(77) This relay device **93** may be configured to generate, from that second distribution section and from template values of pressure, a pressure of use at a determined throughput for the filling of the service brake pressure chamber **13**.

(78) These template values of pressure may correspond to service brake and emergency brake pressure settings and preset, respectively coming from the service brake pipe **75**, the emergency brake pipe **76** and from the preset pipe **79**.

(79) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise, on the service brake pipe **75**, a pressure reducing valve **87** configured to limit the pressure value for example here to approximately 4 bars as well as a distribution device **88** formed for example by a monostable solenoid valve and configured to receive a control signal corresponding to a service brake setting CFS.

(80) When the setting value CFS is null, the distribution device **88** may be configured to interrupt the service brake pipe **75**; and when the setting value CFS is not null, the device **88** may be configured to authorize the passage of a pneumatic pressure agent, called first pressure agent, to the relay device **93** which receives a service brake pressure template value, and which generates a service brake pressure to supply the service brake pressure chamber **13** for the braking of the vehicle.

(81) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise a pressure sensor **90** connected to a tapping **89** onto the service brake pipe **75** and which makes it possible to control the service brake pressure template value.

(82) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise a venting solenoid valve **91** connected by the tapping **89** onto the service brake pipe **75** and which makes it possible to vent that pipe via a

venting aperture **92** on that solenoid valve **91**.

(83) The solenoid valve **91** may be monostable and be configured for receiving a control signal corresponding to a work setting CT and for operating in reverse.

(84) When the setting value CT is not null, the solenoid valve **91** may be configured to interrupt the communication of the service brake pipe **75** with the venting aperture **92**; and when the setting value CT is null, that solenoid valve **91** may be configured to allow the communication of that pipe **75** with that venting aperture **92**.

(85) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise, on the emergency brake pipe **76**, a distribution device **96** formed here by a monostable solenoid valve operating in reverse and configured to receive a control signal corresponding to an emergency brake setting CFU.

(86) When the setting value CFU is not null, the distribution device **96** may be configured to interrupt the emergency brake pipe **76**; and when the setting value CFU is null, the device **96** may be configured to authorize the passage of a pneumatic pressure agent to the relay device **93** which receives an emergency brake pressure template value and which generates an emergency brake pressure to supply the service brake pressure chamber **13** for the emergency braking of the vehicle.

(87) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise a pressure limiter **95** (or pressure reducing valve) on the emergency brake pipe **76** upstream of the distribution device **96**, which limiter **95** may be controlled according to a load parameter param_C of the vehicle received via a load pipe **77** connected to the limiter **95**; and a pressure sensor **94** which may be tapped onto the load pipe **77**.

(88) The load parameter param_C is an information item representing the vehicle load and may for example concern a single wagon, or several successive wagons or the entirety of the rail vehicle.

(89) It will furthermore be noted that certain parameters of operation of certain rail vehicles may naturally (or initially) be dependent on the vehicle load for example to manage the service brake whereas others are not dependent on the vehicle load.

(90) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise on the brake pipe **72**, a pressure switch **97** downstream of the relay device **93** and configured to check whether or not a pneumatic pressure agent, has a pressure value at least greater than a predetermined threshold value, in the brake pipe **72** and therefore whether there is a pressure in the service brake pressure chamber **13**.

(91) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise on the brake pipe **72** an anti-wheel-slide device **98** here formed by a monostable solenoid valve and configured to receive control signals which correspond to anti-wheel-slide parameters Param_AE of the vehicle; so as to ensure the effectiveness of the rail vehicle braking.

(92) These anti-wheel-slide parameters Param_AE are information items representing the anti-wheel-slide or the wheel-slide of the vehicle and may for example correspond to the load of the vehicle, to its speed of locomotion as well as to the service and/or emergency brake template values.

(93) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise on its control pipe **78** a pressure reducing valve **99** configured to limit the pressure value for example here to approximately 6 bars.

(94) The control and actuation unit **3** may comprise one or more pneumatic distribution devices **51** dedicated to the parking brake pipe **71** and to the preset pipe **79**.

(95) The pneumatic distribution device or devices **51** may be formed for example by monostable distributors, also called solenoid valves, connected to the control pipe **78** and/or the brake pipe **72** via the preset pipe **79** and/or the relay device **93**, and/or the parking brake pipe **71**.

(96) The pneumatic distribution device or devices **51** may be controlled via a control line **46** configured to distribute a setting for application of the parking brake CFP.

(97) When the parking brake application setting CFP is null, this may mean that the parking brake **7** must be applied. In this case this is referred to as a security application.

(98) If required, the pneumatic distribution device or devices **51** may be configured to disconnect the parking brake pressure chamber **25** from the auxiliary reservoir **73**.

(99) The parking brake pressure chamber **25** can then be vented and the blocking finger **20** can come to immobilize the rod **21** of the piston **8**. The parking brake is applied. It is in what is referred to as an engaged state.

(100) At the same time, the pneumatic distribution device or devices **51** may be configured to connect the service brake pressure chamber **13** via the brake pipe **72** to the auxiliary reservoir **73** via the control pipe **78** and the supply and distribution pipe **74**.

(101) Authorization may thus be given to the passage of a pneumatic pressure agent, referred to as third pressure agent, to the relay device **93** which receives a pressure preset template value and which generates a pressure preset to supply the service brake pressure chamber **13** if required.

(102) To release application of the parking brake **7**, a non-null setting for application of the parking brake CFP may be conveyed in the control line **46**.

(103) If required, the pneumatic distribution device or devices **51** may be configured to connect the parking brake pressure chamber **25** via the parking brake pipe **71** to the auxiliary reservoir **73** via the control pipe **78** and the supply and distribution pipe **74**.

(104) Authorization may thus be given for the passage of a pneumatic pressure agent, referred to as second pressure agent, directly to the parking brake pressure chamber **25** via the parking brake pipe **71**. The blocking finger **20** is then withdrawn into that chamber and releases the rod **21** of the piston **8**.

(105) At the same time, the pneumatic distribution device or devices **51** may be configured to disconnect the service brake pressure chamber **13** from the auxiliary reservoir **73**.

(106) The passage of the third pneumatic pressure agent to the relay device **93** may thus be prohibited and the latter thus does not receive a pressure preset template value and vents the pressure preset if required.

(107) The parking brake is then not applied. It is in what is referred to as a disengaged state.

(108) The control and actuation unit **3** comprises an indicator device **100** configured to detect and indicate what the state is of the parking brake **7** and/or of the service brake **6**.

(109) The indicator device **100** indicating what the state is of the parking brake **7** and/or of the service brake **6** is configured to receive an item of information representing the venting and/or the supply of the parking brake pressure chamber **25**, via a first state pipe **52** which is connected to the unlocking part **29** for unlocking the parking brake **7**.

(110) The indicator device **100** configured to receive an item of information representing the supply of the service brake pressure chamber **13** by the third pneumatic pressure agent, via a second state pipe **53** which is connected to the preset pipe **79**.

(111) The indicator device **100** configured to receive an item of information representing the supply of the service brake pressure chamber **13** by the first pneumatic pressure agent, via a third state pipe **54** which is connected to the service brake pipe **75**.

(112) This indicator device **100** may be configured to retrieve these items of information for example directly from the parking brake pipe **71** and/or from the preset pipe **79** and/or from the service brake pipe **75**.

(113) FIG. 3 shows in more detail the indicator device **100** indicating what the state is of the parking brake **7** and/or of the service brake **6**.

(114) The indicator device **100** is provided with a first switching system **56** provided for indicating the state of the parking brake **7**.

(115) The first switching system **56** may comprise a first parking contactor device **55** mechanically connected to the unlocking part **29**, a second parking contactor device **57** which is connected via the first state pipe **52** to the first parking contactor device **55**, a third parking contactor device **58** and a fourth parking contactor device **59** which are each connected via the second state pipe **53** to the preset pipe **79**.

(116) The second parking contactor device **57** may be electrically supplied via an electrical source **60**.

(117) The third and fourth respective parking contactor devices **58** and **59** are furthermore respectively connected to the second parking contactor device **57** and to respective visual parking indication devices **61** and **62**.

(118) The third and fourth respective parking contactor devices **58** and **59** may for example be formed by pressure switches or sensors.

(119) The indicator device **100** is provided with a second switching system **64** provided for indicating the state of the parking brake **6**.

(120) The second switching system **64** may comprise a first service contactor device **65** which is connected to the first supply pipe **72**, a second service contactor device **66** which is connected via the third state pipe **54** to the service brake pipe **75**, a third service contactor device **67** connected via the second state pipe **53** to the preset pipe **79**, and a fourth service contactor device **68** connected via the second state pipe **53** to the preset pipe **79**.

(121) The first and second service contactor devices **65** and **66** may be electrically supplied via a respective electrical source **171**, **172**.

(122) The third and fourth respective parking contactor devices **67** and **68** are furthermore respectively connected to the second parking contactor device **65** and **66**, and to respective visual parking indication devices **69** and **19**.

(123) The first, second, third and fourth service contactor devices **65**, **66**, **67** and **68** may for example be formed by pressure switches or sensors.

(124) With reference to FIGS. **4** to **7** a description will be given of the operation of the first switching system **56** provided to indicate the state of the parking brake **7**, denoted IFP in FIG. **4**.

(125) The IFP information may for example result in a red indicator light generated by the visual parking indication device **62** when the parking brake **7** is in the engaged state; whereas it may for example result in a green indicator light generated by the visual parking indication device **61** when the parking brake **7** is in the disengaged state.

(126) In particular, when the second parking contactor device **57** receives an item of information from the first state pipe **52** according to which the unlocking part **29** is in an unlocking position and the fourth parking contactor device **59** receives an item of information from the second state pipe **53** according to which there is a preset setting in the preset pipe **79** corresponding to a setting for application of the parking brake **7**, this means that the parking brake **7** is in the engaged state and the visual parking indication device **62** is then on.

(127) Conversely, if the second parking contactor device **57** receives an item of information from the first state pipe **52** according to which the unlocking part **29** is in an unlocking position, and the third parking contactor device **58** receives an item of information from the second state pipe **53** according to which there is no preset setting in the preset pipe **79** corresponding to a setting for application of the parking brake **7**, this means that the parking brake **7** is in the disengaged state and the visual parking indication device **61** is then on.

(128) The third and fourth respective parking contactor devices **58** and **59** may for example be actuated according to a predetermined threshold of the pressure preset value, or of the pressure preset template value.

(129) FIGS. **5** to **7** show very diagrammatically what are the conditions of use of the parking brake **7** and/or of the service brake **6** in which the first parking contactor device **55** sends an item of information relating to the position of the unlocking part **29** to the second parking contactor device **57** via the first state pipe **52**.

(130) In FIG. **5**, the first supply pipe **72** does not supply the pressure chamber of the service brake **6** and the second supply pipe **71** supplies the pressure chamber of the parking brake **7**; such that the parking brake **7** is in the disengaged state. The unlocking part **29** is in an unlocking position and the first parking contactor device **55** sends the information to the second parking contactor device **57**.

(131) In FIG. **6**, the first supply pipe **72** supplies the pressure chamber of the service brake **6** and the second supply pipe **71** does not supply the pressure chamber of the parking brake **7**; such that

the parking brake **7** is in the engaged state. The unlocking part **29** is in a locking position and the first parking contactor device **55** sends the information to the second parking contactor device **57**.
(132) In FIG. **7**, the first supply pipe **72** does not supply the pressure chamber of the service brake **6** and the second supply pipe **71** does not supply the pressure chamber of the parking brake **7**; such that the parking brake **7** is in the disengaged state. The unlocking part **29** is in an unlocking position after having been manually shifted, and the first parking contactor device **55** sends the information to the second parking contactor device **57**.

(133) As explained above, the information sent by the first parking contactor device **55** to the second parking contactor device **57** via the first state pipe **52** is processed in combination with the information representing the preset setting in the preset pipe **79** for the purpose of indicating whether the parking brake **7** is in the engaged state or in the disengaged state.

(134) With reference to FIG. **8** the operation will now be described of the switching system **64** provided to indicate the state of the service brake **6**, denoted IFS.

(135) The IFS information may for example result in a red indicator light generated by the visual service indication device **19** when the service brake **6** is in the engaged state; whereas it may for example result in a green indicator light generated by the visual service indication device **69** when the service brake **6** is in the disengaged state.

(136) In particular, when the first service contactor device **65** receives an item of information from the first supply pipe **72** according to which the latter supplies the service brake pressure chamber **6** and when the fourth service contactor device **68** receives an item of information from the second state pipe **53** according to which there is no preset setting in the preset pipe **79**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the engaged state and the visual service indication device **19** is then turned on.

(137) Moreover, if the second service contactor device **66** receives an item of information from the third state pipe **54** according to which there is a service brake setting in the service brake pipe **75** and if the fourth service contactor device **68** receives an item of information from the second state pipe **53** according to which there is a preset setting in the preset pipe **79** corresponding to a setting for application of the parking brake **7**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the engaged state and the visual service indication device **19** is then on.

(138) Conversely, when the first service contactor device **65** receives an item of information from the first supply pipe **72** according to which the latter does not supply the service brake pressure chamber **6** and when the third service contactor device **67** receives an item of information from the second state pipe **53** according to which there is no preset setting in the preset pipe **79**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the disengaged state and the visual service indication device **69** is then turned on.

(139) Moreover, if the second service contactor device **66** receives an item of information from the third state pipe **54** according to which there is no service brake setting in the service brake pipe **75** and if the third service contactor device **67** receives an item of information from the second state pipe **53** according to which there is a preset setting in the preset pipe **79** corresponding to a setting for application of the parking brake **7**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the disengaged state and the visual service indication device **69** is then on.

(140) The first service contactor device **65** may for example be actuated according to a predetermined threshold of service brake pressure value, the second service contactor device **66** may for example be actuated according to a predetermined threshold of service brake pressure template value, and the third and fourth respective service contactor devices **67** and **68** may for example be actuated according to a predetermined threshold of pressure preset value, or of pressure preset template value.

(141) FIG. **9** illustrates a first variant embodiment of the second switching system **64** provided to indicate the state of the service brake **6**, denoted IFS.

(142) The first and second service contactor devices **65** and **66** are mounted here in series, rather than in parallel, and the third and fourth service contactor devices **67** and **68** are eliminated.

(143) When the first service contactor device **65** receives an item of information from the first supply pipe **72** according to which the latter supplies the service brake pressure chamber **6** and when the second service contactor device **66** receives an item of information from the third state pipe **54** according to which there is a service brake setting in the service brake pipe **78**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the engaged state and the visual service indication device **19** is then turned on.

(144) Conversely, if the first service contactor device **65** receives an item of information from the first supply pipe **72** according to which the latter does not supply the pressure chamber of the service brake **6**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the disengaged state and the visual service indication device **69** is then turned on.

(145) Furthermore, when the first service contactor device **65** receives an item of information from the first supply pipe **72** according to which the latter supplies the service brake pressure chamber **6** and when the second service contactor device **66** receives an item of information from the third state pipe **54** according to which there is no service brake setting in the service brake pipe **79**, this means that the service brake **6** should be in the disengaged state and the visual service indication device **69** is then turned on. However, this variant embodiment does not enable a possible service brake control failure to be intercepted.

(146) FIG. **10** illustrates a second variant embodiment of the second switching system **64** provided to indicate the state of the service brake **6**, denoted IFS. This second variant differs from the embodiment illustrated in FIG. **8** in that it is what is referred to as a series arrangement rather than parallel. Furthermore, contrary to the first variant illustrated in FIG. **9** which does not take into account the preset setting, the second variant takes into account the preset setting like the embodiment illustrated in FIG. **8**.

(147) In particular, in FIG. **10**, the third service contactor device **67** is interposed between the first and second service contactor devices **65** and **66**.

(148) When the first service contactor device **65** receives an item of information from the first supply pipe **72** according to which the latter supplies the service brake pressure chamber **6**, when the third service contactor device **67** receives an item of information from the second state pipe **53** according to which there is a preset setting in the preset pipe **79** constituting a setting for application of the parking brake **7**, and when the second service contactor device **66** receives an item of information from the third state pipe **54** according to which there is a service brake setting in the service brake pipe **78**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the engaged state and the service visual indication device **19** is turned on.

(149) Moreover, if the first service contactor device **65** receives an item of information from the first supply pipe **72** according to which the latter supplies the service brake pressure chamber **6** and if the third service contactor device **67** receives an item of information from the second state pipe **53** according to which there is no preset setting in the preset pipe **79**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the engaged state and the visual service indication device **19** is then turned on.

(150) Conversely, when the first service contactor device **65** receives an item of information from the first supply pipe **72** according to which the latter supplies the service brake pressure chamber **6**, when the third service contactor device **67** receives an item of information from the second state pipe **53** according to which there is a preset setting in the preset pipe **79** constituting a setting for application of the parking brake **7**, and when the second service contactor device **66** receives an item of information from the third state pipe **54** according to which there is no service brake setting in the service brake pipe **78**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the disengaged state and the service visual indication device **69** is turned on.

(151) Moreover, if the first service contactor device **65** receives an item of information from the first supply pipe **72** according to which the latter does not supply the pressure chamber of the service brake **6**, this means that the service brake **6** is in the disengaged state and the visual service indication device **69** is then turned on.

(152) FIG. 11 illustrates a third variant embodiment of the second switching system 64 provided to indicate the state of the service brake 6, denoted IFS.

(153) The second and third service contactor devices 66 and 67 are pneumatic threshold valves which are supplied directly via the first supply pipe 72. The first and fourth service contactor devices are eliminated.

(154) In particular, when the first supply pipe 72 supplies the service brake pressure chamber 6 and when the third service contactor device 67 receives an item of information from the second state pipe 53 according to which there is no preset setting in the preset pipe 79, this means that the service brake 6 is in the engaged state such that the visual service indication device 19 is then turned on.

(155) Moreover, when the first supply pipe 72 supplies the service brake pressure chamber 6, when the third service contactor device 67 receives an item of information from the second state pipe 53 according to which there is a preset setting in the preset pipe 79 constituting a setting for application of the parking brake 7, and when the second service contactor device 66 receives an item of information from the third state pipe 54 according to which there is a service brake setting in the service brake pipe 78, this means that the service brake 6 is in the engaged state and the service visual indication device 19 is then turned on.

(156) Conversely, when the first supply pipe 72 does not supply the pressure chamber of the service brake 6, or else when the first supply pipe 72 supplies the service brake pressure chamber 6, when the third contactor device 67 receives an item of information from the second state pipe 53 according to which there is a preset setting in the preset pipe 79 constituting a setting for application of the parking brake 7, and when the second service contactor device 66 receives an item of information from the third state pipe 54 according to which there is no service brake setting in the service brake pipe 78, this means that the service brake 6 is in the disengaged state and the visual service indication device 69 is then visible.

(157) In a variant not illustrated, the rail vehicle braking system is not of the same kind as that described with reference to FIG. 1, but rather a rail vehicle braking system with a parking brake having a spring, of the type described in European patent application EP 2 154 040.

(158) In such a rail vehicle braking system with a parking brake having a spring, the present invention gives the possibility of providing a parking brake indicator device which is provided to indicate the engaged or disengaged state of the latter.

(159) The information relating to the state of the parking brake may for example result in a red indicator light generated by a visual parking indication device when the parking brake is in the engaged state; whereas it may for example result in a green indicator light generated by another visual parking indication device when the parking brake is in the disengaged state.

(160) In particular, the parking brake indicator device may comprise a first parking contactor device mechanically connected to an unlocking part of the same type as that described above and provided to pass the parking brake from its engaged state to its disengaged state.

(161) The parking brake indicator device may further comprise a second parking contactor device which is connected via a first state pipe to the first parking contactor device.

(162) The parking brake indicator device may also comprise a third contactor device connected to another state pipe itself connected either to a supply pipe of the parking brake, or to a setting pipe of the parking brake.

(163) The second and the third parking contactor devices may be electrically supplied via a respective electrical source.

(164) When the second parking contactor device receives an item of information from the state pipe according to which the unlocking part is in a locking position and the third parking contactor device receives an item of information from the other state pipe according to which there is a parking brake setting and/or when the parking brake pressure chamber of the system is not supplied, corresponding to a setting for application of the parking brake, this means that the

parking brake is in the engaged state and one of the visual parking indication devices is then turned on.

(165) When the second parking contactor device receives an item of information from the state pipe according to which the unlocking part is in an unlocking position, this means that the parking brake is in the disengaged state and the other of the visual parking indication devices is then turned on, whatever the item of information received by the third parking contactor device or device.

(166) More generally, the invention is not limited to the examples described and illustrated.

Claims

1. A rail vehicle braking system comprising: a body delimiting one or both of a service brake pressure chamber or a parking brake pressure chamber; a parking brake movable relative to the body; an unlocking part for unlocking the parking brake connected to the parking brake chamber and accessible from outside the body; and a parking brake indicator device, wherein the indicator device is configured to receive a first item of information representing a position of the unlocking part via a first state pipe configured to be connected to the unlocking part, the indicator device also configured to receive at least one second item of information representing one or more of the supply or venting of one or more of a service brake pressure chamber or the parking brake pressure chamber, the indicator device configured to receive the at least one second item of information via at least one of a second state pipe or a third state pipe configured to be connected to one or more of a service brake pipe or to a parking brake, the first item of information being processed in combination with the at least one second item of information to detect and indicate an engaged state or a disengaged state of the parking brake.

2. The rail vehicle braking system according to claim 1, wherein the indicator device is configured to receive a third item of information representing the supply of the service brake pressure chamber by a pneumatic pressure agent, the indicator device configured to receive the third item of information via the second state pipe which is configured to be connected to a parking brake setting pipe, the indicator device configured to receive a fourth item of information representing the supply of the service brake pressure chamber by another pneumatic pressure agent, the indicator device configured to receive the fourth item of information via the third state pipe which is configured to be connected to a service brake pipe.

3. The rail vehicle braking system according to claim 1, wherein the unlocking part is coupled to a switch of the indicator device, the indicator device is mechanically connected to the unlocking part, the unlocking part having a first position and a second position.

4. The rail vehicle braking system according to claim 1, wherein the indicator device comprises a first parking contactor device mechanically connected the unlocking part, a second parking contactor device which is connected to the first parking contactor device via the first state pipe, a third parking contactor device, and a fourth parking contactor device which are each connected via the second state pipe to a parking brake setting pipe, the respective third and fourth parking contactor devices being respectively connected to the second parking contactor device and to respective visual parking indication devices of the indicator device.

5. The rail vehicle braking system according to claim 4, wherein one or more of: (a) the second parking contactor device is electrically supplied via an electrical source or (b) the third and fourth respective parking contactor devices are formed by pressure switches or sensors.

6. The rail vehicle braking system according to claim 4, wherein, when the second parking contactor device receives the first item of information from the first state pipe according to which the unlocking part is in an unlocking position and the fourth parking contactor device receives the second item of information from the second state pipe according to which there is a parking brake setting in the parking brake pipe corresponding to a setting for application of the parking brake, the parking brake is in an engaged state and the visual parking indication device is on.

7. The rail vehicle braking system according to claim 4, wherein, when the second parking contactor device receives the first item of information from the first state pipe according to which the unlocking part is in an unlocking position and the third parking contactor device receives the second item of information from the second state pipe according to which the parking brake setting has a null value in the parking brake pipe, the parking brake is in a disengaged state and the visual parking indication device is then on.
8. The rail vehicle braking system according to claim 1, wherein the indicator device comprises a first parking contactor device mechanically connected to the unlocking part, a second parking contactor device connected to the first parking contactor device via the first state pipe, and a third contactor device connected to another state pipe that is joined either to a supply pipe of the parking brake or to a setting pipe of the parking brake.
9. The rail vehicle braking system according to claim 8, wherein, when one or more of: (a) the second parking contactor device receives the first item of information from the first state pipe according to which the unlocking part is in a locking position and the third contactor device receives the second item of information from the second state pipe according to which there is a parking brake setting or (b) when the parking brake pressure chamber of the system is not supplied, corresponding to a setting for application of the parking brake, the parking brake is in the engaged state and a visual indication device is turned on.
10. The rail vehicle braking system according to claim 8, wherein, when the second parking contactor device receives the first item of information from the first state pipe according to which the unlocking part is in an unlocking position, the parking brake is in the disengaged state and a visual parking indication device is turned on, regardless of the second item of information received by a third parking contactor device.
11. A rail vehicle having brakes with at least one lining or with at least one block, comprising at least one of the rail vehicle braking system according to claim 1, which is configured to act on the at least one lining or on the at least one block of the rail vehicle.
12. A braking system comprising: a parking brake including an unlocking part configured to unlock the parking brake; a parking brake indicator device configured to receive positions of the unlocking part via a first state pipe, the indicator device configured to receive a first indication of one or more of supply or venting of a brake pressure chamber via a second state pipe; and a control and actuation unit configured to detect and indicate an engaged state or a disengaged state of the parking brake based on at least one of the positions received via the first state pipe and the first indication of the one or more of the supply or the venting of the brake pressure chamber.
13. The braking system of claim 12, wherein the indicator device is configured to receive a second indication representation of the supply of the brake pressure chamber, the control and actuation unit configured to detect and indicate the engaged state or the disengaged state of the parking brake based on at least one of the positions received via the first state pipe, the first indication, and the second indication.
14. The braking system of claim 12, wherein the indicator device comprises a first contactor device configured to be connected with the unlocking part of the parking brake, a second contactor device configured to be connected with the first contactor device via the first state pipe, a third contactor device configured to be connected to a parking brake setting pipe, and a fourth contactor device configured to be connected to the parking brake setting pipe, the third and fourth contactor devices connected to the second contactor device and to visual parking indication devices of the indicator device.
15. The braking system of claim 14, wherein the second contactor device is electrically supplied via an electrical source and the third and fourth contactor devices are formed by pressure switches or sensors.
16. The braking system of claim 12, wherein the control and actuation unit is configured to determine that the parking brake is in an engaged state and to activate a visual indication device

responsive to the unlocking part being in an unlocking position of the positions and the first indication of the one or more of the supply or the venting of the brake pressure chamber.

17. The braking system of claim 12, wherein the control and actuation unit is configured to determine that the parking brake is in a disengaged state and to activate a visual indication device responsive to the unlocking part being in an unlocking position of the positions and the first indication representing the venting of the brake pressure chamber.

18. The braking system of claim 12, wherein the control and actuation unit is configured to determine that the parking brake is in an engaged state and to activate a visual indication device responsive to the unlocking part being in an unlocking position and receiving the first indication of the supply of the brake pressure chamber, and the control and actuation unit is configured to determine that the parking brake is in a disengaged state and to activate the visual indication device responsive to the unlocking part being in the unlocking position of the positions and receiving the first indication of the venting of the pressure chamber.

19. The braking system of claim 12, wherein the control and actuation unit is configured to determine that the parking brake is in an engaged state and to activate a visual indication device responsive to the unlocking part being in a locking position of the positions and receiving the first indication of a parking brake setting.

20. The braking system according to claim 19, wherein the visual indication device is a first visual indication device, and the control and actuation unit is configured to determine that the parking brake is in a disengaged state and to activate a second visual indication device responsive to the unlocking part being in an unlocking position regardless of the first indication.
